SURVIVAL-TIPS

Agriculture & Food Systems

Growing food, soil care, seeds, irrigation, food preservation, and resilient food systems.

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How to use this handbook

Use this guide as a learning aid, not as a substitute for official emergency instructions or expert assessment. Every AI-extracted tip must be reviewed before it is treated as verified guidance. Never infer that a wild plant, mushroom, water source, or improvised material is safe based on appearance alone.

1. Use Local, Sustainable Materials

Prioritize locally sourced, sustainably harvested materials for shelter construction to reduce transport costs, environmental impact, and support local economies.

Steps

1. Identify available local materials (wood, sand, etc.).
2. Assess sustainability and environmental impact.
3. Source materials responsibly.
4. Incorporate into shelter design.

Warnings

• Overharvesting can damage local ecosystems.

• Unsustainable sourcing may increase costs.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

2. Plant Underutilized, Climate■Resistant Crops for Micronutrients

Growing low■maintenance, nutrient■rich local species can reduce micronutrient deficiencies.

Steps

1. Identify underutilized crops native to the region (e.g., certain leafy greens, legumes).
2. Prepare soil with compost or organic matter.
3. Plant during appropriate seasons and space for optimal growth.
4. Harvest when mature and incorporate into daily meals.
5. Share surplus with neighbors to build community resilience.

Warnings

• Check for local pests or diseases that may affect these crops.

• Avoid planting in contaminated soils.

• Ensure proper storage to prevent spoilage.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Improving nutrition through home gardening — https://openknowledge.fao.org/items/e2135500-73cb-4855-8cd0-a8bdecb971a5

3. Promote Year■Round Nutritional Diets through Community Gardening

Community■based home gardening programs support continuous access to diverse, nutritious foods.

Steps

1. Organize training workshops for local households.
2. Create shared garden plots or cooperative plots.
3. Develop a schedule for planting, harvesting, and storage.
4. Encourage participation of all age groups, especially children.
5. Monitor nutritional outcomes and adjust practices.

Warnings

• Ensure equitable access to garden space.

• Prevent conflicts over resource allocation.

• Maintain hygiene to avoid foodborne illnesses.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Improving nutrition through home gardening — https://openknowledge.fao.org/items/e2135500-73cb-4855-8cd0-a8bdecb971a5

4. Use Home Gardens to Combat Micronutrient Deficiencies

Diversifying fruit and vegetable production in home gardens can sustainably reduce micronutrient gaps.

Steps

1. Select a variety of colorful fruits and vegetables rich in vitamins and minerals.
2. Plant in succession to provide continuous harvests.
3. Educate families on the nutritional benefits of each crop.
4. Incorporate home■grown produce into daily meals.
5. Track changes in dietary diversity and health indicators.

Warnings

• Avoid over■use of pesticides that may reduce nutrient quality.

• Ensure safe irrigation water to prevent contamination.

• Be mindful of seasonal availability of certain crops.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Improving nutrition through home gardening — https://openknowledge.fao.org/items/e2135500-73cb-4855-8cd0-a8bdecb971a5